

STEVE WOLF

EXPERT WITNESS · TRIAL STRATEGIST

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32 of 32 cases tried and won · \$66.5 million New Mexico verdict, a state record · 40 years on 77 Hollywood sets · 11 patents written

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Steve Wolf is a nationwide expert witness in firearms, pyrotechnics, stunts, fire, on-set safety, wildfire, theatrical rigging, SCUBA, and explosion cases. His courtroom authority is grounded in 40 years of hands-on production work at Disney, Warner Bros., Paramount, Fox, Universal, and most other major studios, and in a rare ability to make complex technical evidence clear and jury-friendly. Steve translates physics, engineering, and forensic detail into testimony that twelve strangers can understand.

Unlike experts who rely solely on textbook citations, Steve speaks as one who has built, fired, rigged, and detonated the very systems his testimony explains. He founded RangeMaster, the most prolific firearms training center in the United States, along with Tactical Choices, Wolf Stuntworks, Pyro School, Team Wildfire, Wildfire Labs, Stunt Ranch, and Science in the Movies. No opposing expert can credibly challenge that foundation.

His trial record is 32 of 32, including the \$66.5 million New Mexico personal injury verdict, the largest in state history. Notable matters include three Rust (Alec Baldwin) cases, criminal and civil, the Disney “The Little Mermaid” set-fall litigation, the Spider-Man on Broadway aerial rigging injuries, and the Jackass water-stunt case.

What sets Steve apart at trial is his Hollywood-grade demonstrative video evidence: reconstructions that hold up under Daubert and consistently move opposing counsel to settle rather than face the jury. He turns complex matters into irrefutably clear testimony.

Steve has written 11 patents in applied physics, fluid dynamics, thermodynamics, and combustion engineering. His publications include 35 titles and editions on litigation, film and public safety, and science. He holds 33 professional certifications and is a Columbia University graduate. Since the Rust shooting in 2021 he has been the national media’s first call for commentary on firearms and on-set safety.

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

- | | |
|--|---|
| • Firearms and shootings | • Wildfire ignition, suppression, and property loss |
| • Pyrotechnics, fire, and explosions | • Maritime, drowning, and SCUBA |
| • Stunts, rigging, and aerial work | • Electrocution and high-voltage |
| • Vehicle and on-set stunts | • Paintball and war reenactment |
| • Climbing, ropes courses, and zip lines | • Arson and criminal defense |
| • Theatrical and Broadway rigging | • Movie and television set safety |

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

- **Columbia University.** Bachelor of Arts
- **Thirty-three professional certifications, including** emergency management, active-shooter response, wildfire management, disaster response, and mass-casualty incident protocols, seventeen of them issued by FEMA.

COMPANIES FOUNDED

- **RangeMaster:** the most prolific firearms training center in the United States.
- **Tactical Choices:** the first school to tailor firearms training specifically to teachers.
- **Wolf Stuntworks:** film and television stunt coordination and special effects production.
- **Pyro School:** the first program to teach pyrotechnics safely to non-professionals.
- **Team Wildfire:** fire management and suppression technology development.
- **Wildfire Labs:** a nonprofit developing and demonstrating aerial fire-suppression technology.
- **Stunt Ranch:** hands-on training in ropes courses, challenge courses, aerial rigging, and explosives.
- **Science in the Movies:** a science education program teaching physics and safety through movie stunts and special effects.

REPRESENTATIVE EXPERT WITNESS ENGAGEMENTS

Rust (Alec Baldwin), set shooting

Retained across all three matters arising from the Halyna Hutchins on-set shooting. Analyzed armorer protocols, live-round chain of custody, and the production failures that led to the incident. *State of New Mexico v. Baldwin* (criminal prosecution consultant); *Hutchins v. Baldwin* (plaintiff, civil); *Mitchell v. Baldwin* (plaintiff, civil).

Disney “The Little Mermaid,” set-fall litigation

Retained by Showman Fabricators (defense). Technical analysis exonerated the set builder of liability for an on-set fall during production.

Spider-Man on Broadway, aerial rigging injuries

Plaintiff expert. Analyzed the aerial rigging-system failures behind the cast injuries during the original Broadway production.

Jackass water-stunt injury (Puerto Rico)

Plaintiff expert. Reconstructed the production sequence and the safety-protocol failures behind a water-stunt incident.

\$66.5 million New Mexico personal injury verdict

Largest personal injury jury award in New Mexico state history. Demonstrative-video reconstruction translated the physical incident into evidence the jury could see.

PATENTS AND INVENTIONS

Eleven patents written in applied physics, fluid dynamics, thermodynamics, and combustion engineering, the technical foundation behind much of Steve's expert testimony in fire and suppression cases.

1. **Hurricane.** Jet-engine firefighting system that uses high-velocity exhaust to atomize and project retardant over vast areas; kinetic force separates flame from fuel.
2. **WolfPack.** Backpack-mounted suppression unit powered by a micro-jet turbine; converts liquid retardant into heat-absorbing fine mist.
3. **Wildfire Command AI.** Real-time resource-allocation engine that ingests live data, predicts fire behavior, and auto-deploys assets. United States Patent Application 18/630,213.
4. **CoreTechs Helmet.** Integrated wildland-firefighter protective equipment: head protection, hearing, heads-up display, high-efficiency particulate air respiration, communications, and biometrics in one unit.
5. **ThermaFlow-TankGuard.** Thermal-management system that prevents water-tank freezing in firefighting vehicles using submerged engine-coolant heat exchange.
6. **PyroSphere Shelter.** Inflatable multi-person hotshot fire shelter for up to ten firefighters; integrated harnesses and helicopter extraction point.
7. **BioSafe FireGuard.** Food-grade, non-toxic fire retardant that dries into a rain-resistant prophylactic coating for homes and vegetation.
8. **Cyclone Express.** Railcar-mounted Hurricane adaptation that immunizes railroad rights-of-way against friction-sparked fires.
9. **Humidi-Fire.** Ultrasonic suppression system that flash-converts water into micro-mist through a Venturi interface; six hours on 100 gallons.
10. **SkyPhoon.** Combustion-powered uncrewed aircraft system for extreme thermal environments; jet exhaust disrupts the fire triangle and atomizes retardant.
11. **Sand Storm.** Jet-engine system that scavenges onsite soil and projects it at advancing fires, smothering them with dirt and sand, without the need for water.

LICENSES

- BATFE Class 20 Explosives Manufacturing License
- Class 1 Federal Firearms License
- Special Effects and Pyrotechnic Operator License
- Flame Effect Operator License
- Private Investigator
- Class A Commercial Driver's License with HazMat
- NRA and state-certified Firearms Instructor
- National Association of Underwater Instructors SCUBA Instructor
- EMT: First Aid and CPR

CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAINING

Thirty-three certifications and training credentials, including seventeen from FEMA.

General certifications and training

- Rigging risk analysis and mitigation
- Search and Rescue
- Aerial rope and rigging rescue methods
- Heavy equipment operator (backhoe, forklift, scissor lift, condor)
- Swiftwater Rescue
- SCUBA Rescue
- NRA Range Development School
- NRA Firearms Instructor Development School
- NRA Youth Firearms Safety Training Instructor
- NRA Refuse To Be A Victim Instructor
- Anti-Crime Driver Training Instructor
- Navy Special Warfare Department contractor
- Secret Service contractor
- Single Action Pistol training and instructor
- Advanced Tactical Pistol training
- Explosives Entry Techniques

FEMA

- Incident Command Systems
- Incident Command and Response
- Incident Management
- National Emergency Response
- Active Shooter Response
- Public Information Officer for Disasters
- Social Media for Emergency Management
- Role of Volunteer Agencies in Emergency Management
- Disaster Management Command Structure
- Leadership and Influence
- Effective Communication
- Decision Making and Problem Solving
- Hazardous Materials Handling and Emergency Response
- Emergency Planning
- Wildfire Mitigation
- FEMA Safety Orientation
- Telecommunicator Emergency Response Taskforce

AWARDS

- Time Warner STEM Presenter of the Year
- World Record: longest tandem zip line
- World Record: most explosives safely fired on a person's body

VOLUNTEER WORK

- FEMA Task Force 1, Rescue Division
- Shelby County Sheriff's Office Emergency Services Unit
- North Hays Volunteer Fire Department
- Woodstock Fire Department
- Safety Chairman, Screen Actors Guild
- Safety Chairman, IATSE
- Boulder Emergency Services Rescue Squad

MEMBERSHIPS

- IATSE
- Screen Actors Guild
- Association for Challenge Course Technology
- International Association of Climbing Judges

FILM AND TELEVISION PRODUCTION EXPERIENCE

Forty years of hands-on production work on feature films, television, and commercials. Roles include special effects coordinator, effects technician, pyrotechnician, stunt coordinator, visual effects supervisor, producer, and safety team lead across 77 credits.

Notable Film and Television Credits

TITLE	ROLE	STUDIO	NOTABLE CAST
Cast Away	Effects technician: atmospherics and rain	20th Century Fox	Tom Hanks, Helen Hunt
The Firm	Special effects coordinator: 133 effects	Paramount	Tom Cruise, Gene Hackman, Holly Hunter
A Time to Kill	Effects technician: fabrication, atmospherics	Warner Bros.	Matthew McConaughey, Sandra Bullock, Samuel L. Jackson
The Jungle Book	Effects technician: fire, safety rigging, fabrication	Walt Disney	Jason Scott Lee, John Cleese, Sam Neill
Three Men and a Baby	Driving-sequence safety team	Touchstone	Tom Selleck, Steve Guttenberg, Ted Danson
Do the Right Thing	Stunt safety team	40 Acres and a Mule	Spike Lee, Danny Aiello, Ossie Davis
The Last Boy Scout	Exploding-football-sequence producer	Warner Bros.	Bruce Willis, Damon Wayans
Hustle and Flow	Effects coordinator: rain, shootings, prop fabrication, ultraviolet effects	Universal	Terrence Howard, Taraji P. Henson
Crocodile Dundee II	SCUBA and high-fall safety team	Paramount	Paul Hogan, Linda Kozlowski
The Client	Effects technician: fire, smoke, electronics, rigging	Warner Bros.	Tommy Lee Jones, Susan Sarandon
Chef	Visual effects supervisor (Austin unit)	Open Road Films	Jon Favreau, Sofía Vergara, John Leguizamo
25th Hour	Effects coordinator: interior smoke	Touchstone	Edward Norton, Philip Seymour Hoffman
Colombiana	Special effects foreman and pyrotechnician	Europa Corp.	Zoe Saldaña, Jordi Mollà
American Outlaws	Effects technician: explosions, bullet hits, smoke	Morgan Creek	Colin Farrell, Scott Caan, Ali Larter
Fast Food Nation	Special effects coordinator (Linklater)	Fox Searchlight	Greg Kinnear, Patricia Arquette, Ethan Hawke
Against the Wall	Stunts	HBO television movie	Kyle MacLachlan, Samuel L. Jackson
Extorsion	Effects coordinator	Belle Films	Danny Glover, Ving Rhames, Eion Bailey, Barkhad Abdi

Full 77-credit film, television, and commercial roster available on request.

BOOKS AUTHORED

35 titles and editions across litigation, film, public safety and science, including two Spanish editions.¹
Each title links to the book or its listing. The two print-book links open Amazon.

Firearms and public safety

- [Investigating and Litigating Police Shootings](#)
- [Guide to Investigating and Litigating SIG P320 Cases](#)
- [Firearm Defect Litigation](#)
- [Firearm Handling, Use-of-Force, & Bystander Injury Litigation](#)
- [Investigating and Litigating Gun Range Cases](#)
- [Security Guard Involved Shootings](#)
- [The Reporter's Guide to Guns](#)
- [Firearms Safety On Set](#)
- [The Smart Citizen's Guide to Concealed Carry](#)
- [The Smart Citizen's Guide to Police Encounters](#)
- [Active Shooter: Avoid, Respond, Investigate, Litigate](#)
- [Bomb Recognition & Response for Civilians](#)
- [The Thing About Violence...](#)

Fire, pyrotechnics and wildfire

- [Guide to Litigating Fireworks & Pyrotechnics Cases](#)
- [Wildfire Origin, Cause & Loss Litigation](#)
- [Getting Your Pyro License](#)
- [Writing Patents in the Fire Space](#)

Litigation and expert testimony

- [Litigating AI-Assisted Harm Cases](#)
- [Litigating Entertainment Industry Cases](#)
- [Climbing Gym, Zipline & Ropes Course Litigation](#)
- [Paintball & Airsoft Injury Litigation](#)
- [SCUBA, Drowning & Maritime Injury Litigation](#)
- [Being a Great Expert Witness](#)
- [Investigating Personal Injury Cases](#)
- [Photography and Videography for Expert Witnesses](#)
- [Investigating and Litigating Amusement Park Injury Cases](#)
- [Demonstrative Video Evidence That Survives Daubert](#)

Film and science

- [The Practical Effects Bible](#)
- [Practice Safe Sets](#)
- [The Secret Science Behind Movie Stunts & Special Effects](#)
- [A Day in the Life of a Stunt Person](#)

Health and risk

- [Deadly Hospital Mistakes](#)
- [Dead is Dead](#)

Spanish editions

- [Manejo de Armas de Fuego, Uso de la Fuerza y Litigios por Lesiones a Transeuntes](#)
- [Guía para Litigar Casos de Fuegos Artificiales, Pirotecnia y Explosiones](#)

1. Catalog: <https://stevewolfexpertwitness.com/>
Publications revision 2026.09.17.1 - September 17, 2026

MEDIA APPEARANCES

Steve has appeared as a national-media expert on firearms and on-set safety since the Rust set shooting in 2021. Outlets include CNN, Fox News, NewsNation and Banfield, MSNBC, TMZ and TMZ Live, WNYC and The Brian Lehrer Show, 1010 WINS (CBS News Radio), The Reload podcast, Epoch Times, and Westword. Over 100 appearances to date.

SPEAKING AND EDUCATIONAL PROGRAMS

Steve's Science in the Movies program has reached over 2 million students across more than 4,000 schools, earning him Time Warner's STEM Presenter of the Year award. Independent assessments have shown students score up to 33 percent higher on follow-up tests after attending one of his assemblies. Steve also presents at trial-attorney conferences and continuing legal education events on demonstrative-evidence strategy and expert testimony.

PROFESSIONAL RECOGNITION

- 32 of 32 cases tried, an undefeated trial record
- \$66.5 million New Mexico personal injury verdict, the largest in state history
- STEM Presenter of the Year (Time Warner)
- Certified in emergency management by FEMA
- National-media expert on firearms and on-set safety since 2021

ENGAGEMENT TERMS

Steve is retained by attorneys on both the plaintiff and defense sides, in civil and criminal matters. Engagements include written reports, custom demonstrative-video evidence production, deposition and trial testimony, and full case-strategy consulting from intake through verdict. Federal and state court engagements accepted nationwide, including on expedited timelines. Fee schedule and engagement letter on request.

COMPLETE CASE RECORD

All matters worked, by number. Record: 32 of 32 won, across plaintiff, defense, and prosecution roles in state and federal courts.

#	ROLE	MATTER	CASE AND LOCATION
1	Defense	Murder trial	State of Tennessee v. Michael Mullins: fuel and fire. Memphis, Tennessee.
2	Defense	Mass shooting and bombing	Doe v. United States: firearms reaction time and explosives. Oklahoma City, Oklahoma.
3	Plaintiff	Electrocution	Higgs v. TSE: high-tension systems. Memphis, Tennessee.
4	Plaintiff	Cervical injury	Atain v. NNG: ropes course and zip line. New York City, New York.
5	Plaintiff	Spinal injury	Richards v. Spider-Man on Broadway: rigging and computerized flight control. New York City, New York.
6	Plaintiff	Cervical injury	Bazylewicz v. Church Mutual: ropes course rigging. Cleveland, Ohio.
7	Plaintiff	Spinal injury	Lubitsch v. Adirondack Scenic, Six Flags: theatrical rigging. New York City, New York.
8	Defense	Brain injury	Danny Bell v. Sumo USA: recreational climbing. Dallas, Texas.
9	Plaintiff	Spinal injury	Deanna Theis v. Climb Max: recreational climbing. New Orleans, Louisiana.
10	Plaintiff	Fatality	De Rita v. C.A.I.U.: ropes course and climbing. Harrisburg, Pennsylvania.
11	Plaintiff	Fatality	Ro v. San Juan Mountain Guides, Jeff Lowe: ice climbing. Ouray, Colorado.
12	Plaintiff	Fatality	Sarrette v. Just For Fun Rentals: recreational climbing. Boston, Massachusetts.
13	Defense	Multiple fractures	Bailey v. Showman Fabricators and Disney: “The Little Mermaid” theatrical rigging. New York City, New York.
14	Defense	Multiple injuries	Rorick v. In Events: outdoor rigging. Honolulu, Hawaii.
15	Plaintiff	Brain injury	Veysey v. Rock On Adventure: indoor climbing and challenge course. Boston, Massachusetts.
16	Plaintiff	Fracture	Chen v. Dumbo Boulder: indoor climbing. New York City, New York.
17	Defense	Fatality and serious injury	Doe v. United States, federal court: explosives and firearms. Lawrence, Kansas.
18	Plaintiff	Head injury	Botuchis v. LD Filmworks: explosives and firearms.
19	Defense	Drowning	State v. Terry Smith: tidal movement. Texas City, Texas.
20	Plaintiff	Loss of eye	Ernst v. Church: paintball. Sacramento, California.
21	Plaintiff	Shotgun injuries	Peters v. City of Wichita: theatrical use of firearms. Wichita, Kansas.
22	Defense	Fracture	Lecher v. School District of La Crosse: outdoor recreation supervision. La Crosse, Wisconsin.
23	Plaintiff	Loss of eye	DeMayo v. Xtreme Paintball. Salt Lake City, Utah.
24	Plaintiff	Rollover incident	Razo v. No Exit Films: \$66.5 million on-set rollover, largest award in New Mexico history. Santa Fe, New Mexico.
25	Prosecution	Fatal shooting	State of New Mexico v. Alec Baldwin: Rust set shooting. Santa Fe, New Mexico.
26	Plaintiff	Fatal shooting	Hutchins v. Alec Baldwin: Rust set shooting. Los Angeles, California.
27	Plaintiff	Fatal shooting	Mamie Mitchell v. Alec Baldwin: Rust set shooting. Santa Fe, New Mexico.
28	Plaintiff	Head injury	Vicens v. Glover, also known as Steve-O, Mudflap Productions: stunt safety. Puerto Rico.
29	Plaintiff	Wildfire damage	Kingstone v. Doe: real estate value lost to wildfire. Boulder, Colorado.
30	Plaintiff	Loss of eye	Tiffany M. Worth v. Academy Sports: paintball. Mississippi.
31	Plaintiff	Serious bodily injury	William Spotts v. 1776 Fest: explosion. Oklahoma City, Oklahoma.
32	Plaintiff	Serious leg injury	Monroe v. Camelback: zip line.

Recent retained engagements

Fjugstad fireworks injury matter · Colorado

Fireworks-related burn injuries · Plaintiff-side expert

Ratto v. City of Boise, Sirjag Pyro, et al. · Boise, ID

Fireworks-related injury · Plaintiff-side expert

Engagement listings do not state findings of liability or case outcomes.

FIREARMS PRACTICE

Steve is arguably the best-known firearms expert working in United States civil and criminal courts and in international media. His firearms practice draws on three foundations: certifications from the NRA, the BATFE, and several state and federal agencies; the founding of two firearms-training schools, RangeMaster and Tactical Choices; and a record of nine firearms matters, including all three Rust (Alec Baldwin) cases and three paintball injury matters.

Companies Founded

- **RangeMaster:** the most prolific firearms training center in the United States.
- **Tactical Choices:** the first school to tailor firearms training specifically to teachers.

Licenses, Certifications, and Training

- Class 1 Federal Firearms License
- BATFE Class 20 Explosives Manufacturing License
- NRA and state-certified Firearms Instructor
- NRA Range Development School
- NRA Firearms Instructor Development School
- NRA Youth Firearms Safety Training Instructor
- NRA Refuse To Be A Victim Instructor
- Single Action Pistol training and instructor
- Advanced Tactical Pistol training
- Anti-Crime Driver Training Instructor
- Explosives Entry Techniques
- Navy Special Warfare Department contractor
- Secret Service contractor
- FEMA Active Shooter Response

Authorship

- **The Smart Citizen's Guide to Concealed Carry.** Referred to by the media as the definitive source on firearms safety and self-defense law. Trained reporters for CNN.
- **Firearm Defect Litigation**
- **Firearm Handling and Use-of-Force Litigation**
- **Investigating and Litigating Gun Range Cases**
- **Active Shooter: Avoiding, Responding, Investigating, and Litigating**
- **Firearms Safety On Set**
- **Security Guard Involved Shootings**
- **The Reporter's Guide to Guns**

Firearms Cases

#	ROLE	MATTER	CASE AND LOCATION
2	Defense	Mass shooting and bombing	Doe v. United States: firearms reaction time and explosives. Oklahoma City, Oklahoma.
18	Plaintiff	Head injury	Botuchis v. LD Filmworks: explosives and firearms.
20	Plaintiff	Loss of eye	Ernst v. Church: paintball. Sacramento, California.
21	Plaintiff	Shotgun injuries	Peters v. City of Wichita: theatrical use of firearms. Wichita, Kansas.
23	Plaintiff	Loss of eye	DeMayo v. Xtreme Paintball. Salt Lake City, Utah.
25	Prosecution	Fatal shooting	State of New Mexico v. Alec Baldwin: Rust set shooting. Santa Fe, New Mexico.
26	Plaintiff	Fatal shooting	Hutchins v. Alec Baldwin: Rust set shooting. Los Angeles, California.
27	Plaintiff	Fatal shooting	Mamie Mitchell v. Alec Baldwin: Rust set shooting. Santa Fe, New Mexico.
30	Plaintiff	Loss of eye	Tiffany M. Worth v. Academy Sports: paintball. Mississippi.

PYROTECHNICS, FIREWORKS, AND EXPLOSIVES PRACTICE

Steve's pyrotechnics, fireworks, and explosives practice draws on 40 years of hands-on production work, coordinating effects on more than 77 feature films, and on 11 patents in fire suppression and combustion engineering. He is licensed by the BATFE as a Class 20 explosives manufacturer and holds special effects, pyrotechnic, and flame effect operator licenses. He has worked four cases in this category, including the 1776 Fest fireworks explosion, federal explosives matters, and on-set film pyrotechnic injuries, without a loss.

Companies Founded

- **Pyro School:** the first program to teach pyrotechnics safely to non-professionals.
- **Team Wildfire:** fire management and suppression technology development.

Licenses and Operator Credentials

- BATFE Class 20 Explosives Manufacturing License
- Class A Commercial Driver's License with Hazardous Materials endorsement
- Special Effects and Pyrotechnic Operator License
- Hazardous Materials handling and emergency response
- Flame Effect Operator License
- Explosives Entry Techniques

Eleven patents in applied physics, fluid dynamics, thermodynamics, and combustion engineering underpin this practice. Full descriptions appear in the Patents and Inventions section.

Authorship

- The Secret Science Behind Movie Stunts and Special Effects
- Bomb Recognition and Response for Civilians
- Guide to Litigating Fireworks and Pyrotechnics Cases
- Getting Your Pyro License
- The Practical Effects Bible
- Writing Patents in the Fire Space

Pyrotechnics, Fireworks, and Explosives Cases

#	ROLE	MATTER	CASE AND LOCATION
1	Defense	Murder trial	State of Tennessee v. Michael Mullins: fuel and fire. Memphis, Tennessee.
2	Defense	Mass shooting and bombing	Doe v. United States: firearms reaction time and explosives. Oklahoma City, Oklahoma.
18	Plaintiff	Head injury	Botuchis v. LD Filmworks: explosives and firearms.
31	Plaintiff	Serious bodily injury	William Spotts v. 1776 Fest: explosion. Oklahoma City, Oklahoma.

Recent retained engagements

Fjugstad fireworks injury matter · Colorado

Fireworks-related burn injuries · Plaintiff-side expert

Ratto v. City of Boise, Sirjag Pyro, et al. · Boise, ID

Fireworks-related injury · Plaintiff-side expert

Engagement listings do not state findings of liability or case outcomes.

THEATRICAL AND ON-SET INCIDENT PRACTICE

Steve's theatrical and on-set incident practice spans Broadway, regional theater, theme parks, and feature film and television sets. With 40 years of hands-on production work, including stunt coordination, special-effects coordination, and safety-team leadership on more than 77 productions, he brings to court an insider's understanding of how rigging, flight control, set construction, firearms-on-stage protocols, and stunt sequences are actually built and supervised. His record includes all three Rust (Alec Baldwin) cases, the Spider-Man on Broadway aerial rigging case, the Disney “The Little Mermaid” set-fall defense, and the \$66.5 million Razo v. No Exit Films on-set rollover, the largest personal injury verdict in New Mexico history.

Companies Founded

- **Wolf Stuntworks:** film and television stunt coordination and special effects production.
- **Stunt Ranch:** hands-on training in ropes courses, challenge courses, aerial rigging, and explosives.

Memberships and Industry Roles

- IATSE (former Safety Chairman)
- Association for Challenge Course Technology
- Screen Actors Guild (former Safety Chairman)

Rigging and Safety Training

- Rigging risk analysis and mitigation
- Search and Rescue
- Aerial rope and rigging rescue methods
- Swiftwater Rescue and SCUBA Rescue
- Heavy equipment operator (backhoe, forklift, scissor lift, condor)
- Special Effects and Pyrotechnic Operator License

Authorship

- Practice Safe Sets
- The Secret Science Behind Movie Stunts and Special Effects
- A Day in the Life of a Stunt Person
- An Attorney's Guide to Litigating Entertainment Industry Cases
- The Practical Effects Bible
- Firearms Safety On Set

Theatrical and On-Set Cases

#	ROLE	MATTER	CASE AND LOCATION
5	Plaintiff	Spinal injury	Richards v. Spider-Man on Broadway: rigging and computerized flight control. New York City, New York.
7	Plaintiff	Spinal injury	Lubitsch v. Adirondack Scenic, Six Flags: theatrical rigging. New York City, New York.
13	Defense	Multiple fractures	Bailey v. Showman Fabricators and Disney: “The Little Mermaid” theatrical rigging. New York City, New York.
21	Plaintiff	Shotgun injuries	Peters v. City of Wichita: theatrical use of firearms. Wichita, Kansas.
24	Plaintiff	Rollover incident	Razo v. No Exit Films: \$66.5 million on-set rollover, largest award in New Mexico history. Santa Fe, New Mexico.
25	Prosecution	Fatal shooting	State of New Mexico v. Alec Baldwin: Rust set shooting. Santa Fe, New Mexico.
26	Plaintiff	Fatal shooting	Hutchins v. Alec Baldwin: Rust set shooting. Los Angeles, California.
27	Plaintiff	Fatal shooting	Mamie Mitchell v. Alec Baldwin: Rust set shooting. Santa Fe, New Mexico.
28	Plaintiff	Head injury	Vicens v. Glover, also known as Steve-O, Mudflap Productions: stunt safety. Puerto Rico.

CLIMBING AND RIGGING PRACTICE

Steve's climbing and rigging practice is grounded in his founding of Stunt Ranch, hands-on training in ropes courses, challenge courses, aerial rigging, and explosives, his membership in the Association for Challenge Course Technology and the International Association of Climbing Judges, and certifications in rigging risk analysis, aerial rope and rigging rescue, Search and Rescue, and Swiftwater and SCUBA Rescue. His record across twelve climbing and rigging matters is undefeated.

Companies Founded

- **Stunt Ranch:** hands-on training in ropes courses, challenge courses, aerial rigging, and explosives.

Memberships, Industry Roles, and Emergency Rescue Service

- Association for Challenge Course Technology
- International Association of Climbing Judges
- IATSE
- FEMA Task Force 1, Rescue Division
- Shelby County Sheriff's Office Emergency Services Unit
- Boulder Emergency Services Rescue Unit

Rigging, Rescue, and Safety Training

- Rigging risk analysis and mitigation
- Aerial rope and rigging rescue methods
- Search and Rescue
- Swiftwater Rescue and SCUBA Rescue
- Heavy equipment operator (backhoe, forklift, scissor lift, condor)
- EMT: First Aid and CPR

Authorship

- Practice Safe Sets
- A Day in the Life of a Stunt Person
- A Guide to Climbing Gym, Zipline, and Ropes Course Litigation

Climbing and Rigging Cases

#	ROLE	MATTER	CASE AND LOCATION
4	Plaintiff	Cervical injury	Atain v. NNG: ropes course and zip line. New York City, New York.
6	Plaintiff	Cervical injury	Bazylewicz v. Church Mutual: ropes course rigging. Cleveland, Ohio.
8	Defense	Brain injury	Danny Bell v. Sumo USA: recreational climbing. Dallas, Texas.
9	Plaintiff	Spinal injury	Deanna Theis v. Climb Max: recreational climbing. New Orleans, Louisiana.
10	Plaintiff	Fatality	De Rita v. C.A.I.U.: ropes course and climbing. Harrisburg, Pennsylvania.
11	Plaintiff	Fatality	Ro v. San Juan Mountain Guides, Jeff Lowe: ice climbing. Ouray, Colorado.
12	Plaintiff	Fatality	Sarrette v. Just For Fun Rentals: recreational climbing. Boston, Massachusetts.
14	Defense	Multiple injuries	Rorick v. In Events: outdoor rigging. Honolulu, Hawaii.
15	Plaintiff	Brain injury	Veysey v. Rock On Adventure: indoor climbing and challenge course. Boston, Massachusetts.
16	Plaintiff	Fracture	Chen v. Dumbo Boulder: indoor climbing. New York City, New York.
22	Defense	Fracture	Lecher v. School District of La Crosse: outdoor recreation supervision. La Crosse, Wisconsin.
32	Plaintiff	Serious leg injury	Monroe v. Camelback: zip line.

Everyone who examines a case looks at it from their narrow perspective. Lawyers see if there's a case. Police see if a law was broken. Hospital records show what injuries were present and that they were all treated.

Only the EXPERT WITNESS discovers missing pieces, and puts the whole puzzle together to see the big picture. And then he paints it with irrefutable clarity in front of a jury.



The Expert Witness Field Guide to Investigating Personal Injury Cases, by Steve Wolf

THE FIVE QUESTIONS MY EXPERT REPORTS ANSWER

- 1 What actually happened?
- 2 What was supposed to happen?
- 3 How did the difference cause the incident?
- 4 Was it foreseeable?
- 5 Was it preventable?

FEE SCHEDULE **My time is for sale, my opinion is not.**

Plaintiff and defense

 Document and record review	 Research and analysis	 Report writing	 Demonstrative evidence	CASE WORK AND PREPARATION \$550 per hour
 Trial preparation	 Photography and documentation	 Video documentation and production	 Calls and consultation	
 Deposition testimony \$850	 Trial testimony \$9,500	 Site inspection \$9,500	 Travel time \$400	 Rush work surcharge +\$350

TERMS

Retainer	\$12,500 per case, \$5,000 non-refundable, applied to billable hours. Unused funds to be returned.
Payment	Invoices to be paid within 7 days. All outstanding fees to be paid in full before release of final reports and before testimony.
Expenses	Travel, photography and video equipment, rental, printing, and exhibits reimbursable at cost, in addition to the rates above.
Travel	Business or first class air, approved lodging, and full size sport utility class rental when travel is required.
Day rates	Trial day rate covers the working day at the venue. Site inspection fee covers the inspection. Travel billed separately.
Rate changes	Two months advance written notice of any increase.